

TRB-007 — Discovery

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Request: *Add one free invoice submission for prospective customers*

Proposed Solution: TRB-007 — One free invoice submission for prospective customers

What is proposed

- Add a "Try one free submission" entry point on the marketing site / signup flow that requires only an email address + business name + contact phone (no payment method).
- Create a "prospective customer" account state that is allowed exactly one full-fidelity submission against the live Arkansas Tax Rebate Portal pipeline, with all the same eligibility checks as a paid account.
- After the free submission completes (or fails eligibility), present a results page that shows whether they qualify for a rebate, and CTAs to upgrade to a paid plan to submit more invoices.
- Persist the lead with full contact information into CRM / marketing automation so customer success can follow up regardless of whether the prospect converts.
- Hard cap at one free submission per business identifier (federal EIN or business name + email combo) to prevent abuse.

Desired outcome

- Prospective customers can validate eligibility with zero financial commitment, removing the biggest objection to signup.
- The product captures email and contact information for every prospect who tries the free submission, even if they don't convert.
- Sales has a steady inbound of warm leads who have already engaged with the product.
- Abuse (one person making many "free" accounts) is mechanically prevented.

Success criteria

- E2E test: sign up with email only, submit one invoice, see eligibility result, get prompted to upgrade.
- A second attempt with the same business identifier is blocked with a clear "this business has already used its free submission, upgrade to continue" message.
- Marketing dashboard shows: free-submission signups per week, conversion rate to paid, and which industries / city sizes convert best.
- 95th-percentile time from "click Try Free" to "see eligibility result" is ≤ 5 minutes (assuming the user provides invoice data in real time).
- Customer success receives a CRM record for every free-submission signup within 5 minutes of completion.